GARDEN CITY CHURCH
CITY YOUTH

CITY UTH



Preparing you for Kingdom impact in the next generation

City Youth Volunteer Manual

HELLO, READER!

Thank you for having an interest or passion in serving the next generation of future leaders and disciples of Jesus. Here at City UTH, our mission and vision is to make disciples of Jesus through fellowship and fun! We strive to create an environment of community, spiritual growth, and prayer. We want to see the next generation set on fire for Jesus through the power of His presence and we want to help equip them to impact the community around them.

During City UTH training, we plan to cover the following topics: follow-up, discipleship, policies and procedures, room management, conflict resolution, safety, mandatory reporting, and how to notice signs of abuse or neglect. We want to fully equip you to be prepared for as many situations as possible; both spiritual and practical. For specific hubs, such as media or worship, there will be separate training sessions.

Please do not hesitate to reach out with any questions you may have.

Sincerely,

Pr. Hannah Carreras

Pr. Hannah Carreras
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140 Bridge St.
Beverly, MA 01915



WHO WE ARE

MISSION

At City Uth, we disciple and empower youth students to be the gospel witness and world changers God has called them to be in their community and culture.

GOALS

1. To teach youth students the word of God
2. To provide an environment where students can experience the presence and power of God and be transformed from the inside out.
3. To disciple youth students in their Christian walk. To equip them to share their faith and gospel witness with the community around them.

PREREQUISITES

(Attendance requirements can be fulfilled during your time of serving)
18 years or older
Must pass a CORI background check
Available to serve twice a month
Attend NEXT night
Attend Following Jesus
Attendance to Tuesday prayer 1x a month
Faithfully attends Garden City Church services outside of service requirements

WHAT DOES A CITY UTH VOLUNTEER LOOK LIKE?

An excellent City UTH volunteer is passionate about Youth and God's word. They are fun, loving, committed, patient, and love to encourage the Next Generation through prayer, God's word, and discipleship.

CITY UTH FRIDAY SERVICE ROLES

Arrival Time: 5:30 PM

SPEAKER

(Role given upon invitation by Youth Pastor)

- Prepares a message to share (share message with pastor prior to service)
- Can prepare slideshow or media content for a sermon. (Please send in by Wed)
- Pray with students after the message (optional altar time)
- If you have small groups after your message, please prepare questions and give to leaders in advance
- In charge of announcements (not if it is a guest speaker)

MEDIA

Training provided by Pr. Aaron

- Turning on all media (lights, PA system, TVs, instruments, ProPresenter)
- Perform sound check with worship team
- Prepare Lyrics for worship in ProPresenter
- Run ProPresenter during worship service
- Have music playing during games, at beginning of service, and end of service
- After service, turn OFF all media (lights, sound board, microphones, speakers, TV's instruments, laptop)

GAMES

- Prepares a game in advance
- Comes prepared with game materials, if needed.
- Leads game with enthusiasm and encourages students' involvement.

WORSHIP TEAM MEMBER

- Be prepared to play your songs
- Sing/play instruments and be led by the Spirit as you worship
- Attend Tuesday rehearsals and practices before service (Practice is over @ 6:20pm)

WORSHIP TEAM COORDINATOR

(Training provided by Worship Leader/Pastor)

- Plans setlist via the Planning Center app weekly by Sunday
- Conducts team rehearsals on Tuesday nights from 5pm-6pm
- Conducts team rehearsal on Fridays before service from 5:30pm-6:15pm
- Leads the worship team musically and spiritually
- Prepares special prayer or devotional for Tuesday rehearsals
- Coordinates with Worship Leader/Pastor

CITY UTH FRIDAY SERVICE ROLES

POINT PERSON/ FLOATER

- If any person needs help, be there to help them
  - Ex: Someone is having trouble with sound, jump in and help.
- Be prepared to fill any gap that may arise due to emergency cancellation.
- Know the service schedule and roles of each volunteer, and be prepared to answer any questions.
- Check in on worship team
- Lead prayer with team @ 5:30pm
- Introduces the speaker and gives announcements

SOCIAL MEDIA

(training provided by Social Media Manager, serves jointly with CREW)

DESIRED CONTENT:

- 1 post per week for City Youth announcing Friday services.
- 1 story/week
- 2x reels/month
- Runs Instagram Livestream of City Uth Services twice a month.
- Be as creative as possible!
- Submit all posts and graphics to Pr. Hannah.

SET UP/TEAR DOWN

Before service:

- Empty trash can (if full).
- Vacuum
- Line up chairs if not aligned.
- Bring up CITY UTH banner.
- Put parking cones out in the back parking lot (At least 4 to block off the road).

After Service:

- Empty trash and take to the dumpster (DO NOT GO ALONE).
- Vacuum
- Make sure lobby is clear of all trash.
- Put chairs back in neat rows.
- Put outside parking cones away.

SET UP FOOD (ONCE A MONTH)

Before Service:

- Take out all supplies that are needed from the youth closet downstairs.
- Arrange all supplies (plates, utensils, food, etc) in an orderly, neat display.

After Service:

- Clear the table of any trash.
- Put away the remaining supplies back in the youth closet.

FRIDAY SERVICE SCHEDULE

5:30PM : LEADERS AND STUDENT HELPERS ARRIVE

5:30PM: GO THROUGH THE ORDER OF SERVICE TOGETHER AND PRAY

5:45PM: PREPARE FOR SERVICE AND ACCOMPLISH ASSIGNED TASKS

6:30PM : SERVICE STARTS

6:30PM - 6:45PM : LET STUDENTS ARRIVE AND HANG OUT

6:45PM: GAMES

7:05PM: ANNOUNCEMENTS & PRAYER OF TRANSITION TO WORSHIP

7:10PM: WORSHIP & CLOSING PRAYER

7:25PM: OFFERING & INTRO OF SPEAKER

7:25PM: THE MESSAGE

7:50PM: RESPONSE TIME/ PRAYER

8PM: DISMISSAL

8PM - 8:30PM : FINISH ASSIGNED HUB TASKS BEFORE GOING HOME.

ADDITIONAL OPPORTUNITIES

DISCIPLESHIP HOUR

PURPOSE: To teach and equip students with God's word and spiritual guidance through discussion and prayer.

Responsibilities

- To lead and teach the class on the assigned lesson for that week
- Leads discussions with students about the material in the lesson
- Start and end class with prayer
- Use TurthTrek for each lesson
- Please prepare lessons in advance
- Print out fill in handouts for students to write on
- Please provide a PowerPoint or video with the teaching lesson

YOUTH CONVENTION

Youth Convention is a gathering of student ministries within our Network for the purpose of drawing near to God in a high energy, Gospel centered, Spirit empowered environment. This event often ignites a passion for Christ that then is brought back to youth group. It is an opportunity for students to engage in corporate worship, a challenging biblical message and develop like-minded relationships with other students around them. Youth convention is a convention that happens annually for youth students only. Youth will be transported on a van to the location of youth convention and will stay overnight in a hotel with City Uth leadership team, including chaperones. There is a registration form, a photo/video release form, and a registration fee to complete before going on Youth Convention. City Uth leaders are required to attend Youth Convention and Fine Arts with students to help chaperone and support our students.

SUMMER CAMP

Summer Camp is a gathering of student ministries within our Network for the purpose of drawing near to God in a high energy, Gospel centered, Spirit empowered environment. Summer camp gives youth the opportunity to make new friends, have a camp counselor to mentor them, have fun through games, and to encounter the presence of God and experience breakthrough in a new way. Summer Camp is a Monday through Friday, overnight event. There is a registration form, a photo/video release form, and a medical release form to complete before attending camp. City Uth leaders have the opportunity to go as leaders to summer camp with students but are not required to.

ADDITIONAL OPPORTUNITIES

FINE ARTS

Fine Arts is a discipleship tool of the Assemblies of God Youth Ministries designed to help students discover, develop, and deploy their ministry gifts. In a competitive venue, students throughout Southern New England are given the opportunity to have their skills evaluated by qualified ministers, industry professionals and educators who encourage excellence, offer ideas for improvement, and inspire students to use their gifts in the local church, community and around the world. By involving your students in Fine Arts, they will gain experience and develop skills that will last a lifetime. They are also able to obtain scholarships for faith-based colleges. Students can compete at the district-level competition, which happens at the same time as youth convention. If students pass the district level of competition, they advance to compete at the national level of the fine arts competition. City Uth leaders are required to attend Youth Convention and Fine Arts with students to help chaperone and support our students.

OUTINGS

City Uth takes outings once a month on the LAST Friday of every month. The purpose of these outings is to bond together as a youth group through fun activities/trips. Examples are going out to an arcade, going to the beach, going to a retreat, etc. On outings, we do need chaperones to attend; this includes city Uth leaders scheduled for that Friday. On each outing, each chaperone will be assigned a group of students that they are responsible for during the outing.

FUNDRAISERS

City Uth hosts fundraisers every year to help students raise money for youth events, such as Youth Convention, Fine Arts Festival, and Summer Camp. We host multiple different fundraisers so no student has a financial barrier keeping them from going to these events. For these fundraisers, we require involvement from parents and all City Uth Leaders. These fundraisers may include car washs, bake sales, babysitting services, providing to-go meals, etc. During the planning and execution of these fundraisers, our purpose is to serve our community and work together, in unity, to reach our financial goal together.

VOLUNTEER TRAINING

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CITY UTH COMMITMENT FORM

VOLUNTEER POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

- Commits to serving twice a month.
- Must show up one hour before service to set up and prepare.
- Must connect with at least 2 students per service.
- Must pick a hub or hubs to serve in (Hubs: worship, tear down and set up, games, snacks, media, hosting, small groups, follow up, fundraising, outings, etc).
- Must never lay hands on a student without their permission first.
- Must never have a romantic relationship with a student.
- If you have to cancel on the day you are scheduled to serve, please give at least 3 days notice before the day of services. This does not include emergency situations (in immediate danger, sickness, death of a family member, etc.).
- Must instruct students in the ways of the Lord and to live a godly lifestyle. Do not encourage any behavior the Scriptures do not permit.
- Must conduct oneself in a respectful and appropriate way towards other leaders and students. No gossiping, back biting, slandering, screaming, having fits of rage, etc.
- Must commit to living a godly lifestyle and maintaining an active prayer and devotional life outside of City UTH.
- Must participate in a background check.
- Must refrain from any immoral lifestyle while serving as a volunteer: this would include getting drunk, smoking, drugs, sexual immorality, stealing, swearing, etc.
- Look for the dates you are scheduled to serve on the Planning Center App.

SAFETY PROTOCOLS

- Always know the location of a student at all times while they are in the church building.
- Never allow a student to go outside of the building by themselves.
- Please make sure to keep students in the building/ first floor of church during the duration of City Youth (6pm-8pm)
- Always make sure the student is dropped off by parent/guardian and picked up by parent/guardian ONLY. Do NOT allow a student to be picked up by anyone other than their parent/guardian unless there is written or verbal permission given by parent/guardian.
- Two adult leaders must be in the room with students AT ALL TIMES.
- Never leave a student by themselves.
- Never be alone with a student.

DRUG/SUBSTANCES

- Substances can include vape pens, cigarettes, prescription pills, and other various drugs such as cocaine, heroin, etc.
- If a student brings a substance/ drug to youth group and it is NOTICED by one of our youth workers, the substance must be confiscated and locked away in church office until the duration of youth ends.
- Contact parents immediately and have a meeting after youth to inform parents of the event.
- Notify Pastor Hannah immediately.
- If a substance is an illegal substance, call the proper authorities.

WEAPONS

- Weapons can include lighters, razors, tasers, pepper spray, knives, firearms, etc.
- If a student brings a weapon to youth, the weapon must be confiscated immediately and locked away in church office until the duration of youth ends.
- Contact parents immediately and have a meeting after youth to inform parents of the event.
- Notify Pastor Hannah immediately

PHYSICAL ALTERCATION

- In the event there is a physical fight between two students, please separate the two students who are fighting. Separate them from the rest of the group.
- Contact parents immediately and have a meeting after youth to inform parents of the event.
- Notify Pastor Hannah immediately.

SEXUAL ALTERCATION

- In the event there is a sexual altercation between two students, please separate the two students. Keep them separated for the remainder of the youth service.
- Contact parents immediately and have a meeting after service to inform parents of the event.
- Notify Pastor Hannah immediately.

INJURY

- If a student is injured at youth, please utilize the first aid kit for students. Afterwards, please inform Pastor Hannah and make sure parents are informed of injury. In the instance of serious injury, please call 911 and then contact parents immediately.
- If a student has an allergic reaction, first identify if the student has an Epi Pen or other allergy medication to utilize. Make sure the student gets the required medication and then call 911.
- Contact parents immediately and have a meeting after youth to inform parents of the event.
- Notify Pastor Hannah immediately.

COMMUNICATION WITH STUDENTS

FOLLOW-UP COMMUNICATION

- At City Uth, we gather student information to stay in contact with them and their parents. All information collected from students and parents must be put in the check-in app or Planning Center App and is kept strictly confidential.
- If you are tasked with sending a follow-up phone call or text message, please notify Pastor Hannah before doing so.
- Please do not share any personal information you receive from a student.

ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATION

- All communication with students must be above reproach and indicative of healthy boundaries. As with any communication, the content of any electronic communication should be readily available to share with the student ministry leader or a parent.

TEXTING

Texting between ministry leaders and students is permissible only as outlined below. In general, texts should occur in 'group' form, whenever possible. Though students will often reply individually, make effort to text in group form and encourage replies to the group.

- Do not text before 7am or after 9pm unless the texting occurs as part of a programmed ministry activity.
- Do not share photos and/or videos of a sexual or suggestive nature.
- Avoid discussion of ANY sexual topic via texts.
- No social media or texting communication may occur with a student of the opposite gender.

SOCIAL MEDIA COOMUNICATION

- It is not permissible for ministry leaders to use personal accounts to direct message students. All group and direct messaging to/from students should be above reproach, available for supervisory access and originate from a ministry account – not a personal account.
- In the event a student direct messages a ministry leader's personal account, the ministry leader will transfer the thread to the ministry account for reply, if necessary. All students will be counseled to direct communication to the ministry account.
- Avoid discussion of ANY sexual topic via social media.
- Do not comment or reply to a student's post that is inappropriate or questionable.
- Applications that allow anonymous messaging are not permissible.

ONE-TO-ONE INTERACTIONS WITH STUDENTS

Meeting the emotional or spiritual needs of students may occasionally involve interaction on an individual basis. Please observe the following guidelines when interacting with minors:

- The Two Adult Rule should be diligently followed during ministry programs: do not interact alone with an individual student in any room or building.
- In the event you find yourself alone with a single student, move to a room or area occupied by others, or to a location easily observed by others.
- One-to-one meetings with an individual student must occur at a time when others are present and where interactions can be easily observed. Example: If a student desires additional conversation after regular programming has concluded, move to an adjoining room where other staff members or volunteers are present, or into a public space.
- If a closed-door meeting must occur, it should occur on church property, with a second adult present. The door must remain unlocked, and any window treatments open.
- Never hold a one-to-one meeting with a student who is the opposite gender.
- Any ongoing meetings with students (such as counseling, one-to-one discipleship, etc.) should be discussed with Pastor Hannah , and should comply with the Two Adult Rule OR occur in a public, easily observed location

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Please handle every situation on a case by case basis. If you have a student who is acting in a disrespectful way towards leaders or other students, please refer back to our behavior policy.

BEHAVIOR POLICY

- Step 1: The student will be asked to correct the behavior by a leader.
- Step 2: The student will be removed from the room to solve the problem with the leader to avoid distractions.
- Step 3: Parents will be notified of discipline or behavior problems.
- Step 4: A meeting will occur with student, parent, and Pastor Hannah.
- Step 5: The student will not be allowed to attend a ministry event (This is a final measure, but not desired).

If a student is unruly or fails to comply with verbal warnings or instructions, that student will be asked to leave (if not endangered by doing so) or the student's parent will be contacted to pick up the student. Any damage of property will be reported to parents, who will be responsible for repairs.

MANDATORY REPORTING

Mandated reporters are professionals who are statutorily required to report allegations of child maltreatment. Mandated reporter is a person who is required by law to report concerns of child abuse or neglect to DCF. While anyone can make a report to DCF, only those people who are listed are mandated to do so - School personnel, child care providers, mental health professionals and social workers, law enforcement, clergy, the child's advocate, and medical professionals.

YOUR ROLE

You have an individual responsibility to report child abuse or neglect, child trafficking and sexual exploitation and infants who are born with a physical dependence on an addictive drug at birth to DCF. Mandated reports must file a 51A report when acting in their professional capacity and have reasonable cause to believe a child is being maltreated.

REASONABLE CAUSE TO BELIEVE

When there is a collection of facts (injuries, doctors reports, etc), observations (information from the child, change in child's behavior, sexual behavior that is not age appropriate), or knowledge that leads you to believe a child is being abused, neglected, at risk of abuse, or is a victim of sexual exploitation. -If you suspect the child of any of the following conditions, you do NOT need proof to make a report.

VICTIM AND PERPETRATOR OF ABUSE/NEGLECT

Mandated reporters do not make a report against an alleged perpetrator, you make a report on behalf of the CHILD. If you know who the perpetrator is, make the report to DCF.

CHILDREN AT HIGH RISK OF ABUSE:

- Children who identify as LGBTQIA+
- Children with disabilities
- Children under 3 years old

HOW TO REPORT

- Have as much info as possible. (Child name, address, phone number. caregiver info, etc)
- You do not need all of the information to make a report - you can make phone calls to DCF during the week between 9am - 5pm. If there is need to call outside of that time, there is the Child abuse emergency line.
- Beverly DCF phone number: 978-825-3800
- Lynn DCF phone number: 781-477-1600
- After the call, submit a written report 48 hours after call through the 51A form.

HOW TO IDENTIFY NEGLECT

Neglect is when a caregivers actions or inactions cause a child to not receive minimally adequate care resulting in serious physical or emotional harm to that child. When a child is not provided food, clothing, shelter, medical care, supervision, emotional stability and growth. Mandated reporters should make a conclusion not based on what is best for the child but whether the child is experiencing significant harm.

SIGNS OF POSSIBLE NEGLECT

- Sudden changes of behavior or school performance
- Frequently absent from school
- Has not received help for physical or medical problems brought to caregiver's attention
- Has learning problems (or difficulty concentrating) that cannot be attributed to specific physical or psychological causes
- Is always watchful, as though preparing for something bad to happen
- Begs or steals food or money
- Lacks adult supervision
- Is constantly dirty and has severe body odor
- Lacks sufficient clothing for the weather

TYPES OF NEGLECT

- Physical
  - Failing to provide nutrition or medical care
  - Failing to provide a child appropriate mental health services
  - Leaving a child with a dangerous caregiver or no caregiver
- Emotional
  - Ignoring a child's needs
  - Exposing a child to extreme or frequent violence
  - Isolating a child
  - Bullying, berating, belittling, or any action causing a child to have chronic fears.

HOW TO IDENTIFY PHYSICAL ABUSE

Physical abuse is the non-accidental act by a caregiver which causes or creates a substantial risk of physical or emotional injury.

SIGNS OF ABUSE

- Frequent injuries attributed to child's clumsiness
- Injuries that don't fit explanation
- Injuries that appear to have a pattern
- Injuries that that do not fit the developmental stage of a child
- Withdrawn, fearful or extreme behavior

TYPES OF PHYSICAL ABUSE

- Fractures
- Bruises, welts
- Burns
- Cuts, scrapes, abrasions

RED FLAGS

- Shies away from touch or flinches at sudden movements
- Apprehensive when other children cry
- Displays aggressive or verbally abusive language
- Seems withdrawn
- Frightened of parents
- Extreme attentiveness to needs of parents
- Complains of soreness
- Self-harms
- Attempts to hide injuries or bruises
- Displays aggression towards animals
- Violent themes in fantasy, art, etc.

CAREGIVER RED FLAG BEHAVIORS

- Offers illogical explanations of child injury
- Attempts to hide child's injury or protect identity of person responsible
- Excessive anxiety about the child's behavior
- Singles out child as bad or beyond control
- Verbalizes dislike for the child
- Erratic unpredictable behavior
- Has memory lapses

HOW TO IDENTIFY SEXUAL ABUSE

Sexual abuse is a form of child abuse that includes sexual activity. It is the non-accidental act by a caregiver upon a child under 18 or any sexual contact between a caregiver and a child under their care.

LOCATION

Sexual abuse can happen anywhere. It also occurs online through pornography, text messages, or the internet.

AGE OF CONSENT

Teenagers can often be sexually active. This is NOT sexual abuse. In determining whether to file a report, your evaluation should include:

- Youth's age
- The age between partners
- The youth's cognitive and social maturity
- Power imbalances between partners
- Whether coercive factors are present, e.g. drugs or gang involvement

SEXUAL EXPLOITATION

When someone uses their power to coerce, manipulate, or deceive a child into sexual activity in exchange for something the victim needs or wants.

SIGNS OF COMMERCIAL EXPLOITATION OF A MINOR

- Unexplained gifts, excessive cash
- Provocative clothing
- Tattoos or branding
- Drug use
- School truancy
- Chronic running away
- Sexually explicit social media pages
- Participating in sexually explicit videos

CHILD BEHAVIOR RED FLAGS

Perceptible Signs

- Difficulty walking or sitting
- Pain or itching in the genital area
- Torn, stained, or bloody underclothing
- Frequent complaints of stomachaches or headaches
- Venereal disease
- Frequent urinary or yeast infections
- Pregnancy

CHILD BEHAVIOR RED FLAGS (CONT.)

Behavioral Signs

- Withdrawal or chronic depression
- Inappropriate sex play or premature understanding of sex
- Feeling threatened by physical contact, closeness
- Promiscuity
- Child is “parentified,” or overly concerned for siblings
- Poor self-esteem, lack of confidence
- Peer problems, lack of involvement with friends
- Extreme weight change
- Suicide attempts or threats; especially with adolescents
- Hysteria, lack of emotional control
- Sudden school difficulties
- Unprovoked cruelty to animals

ADULT BEHAVIOR RED FLAGS

- Doesn’t respect boundaries when someone says no
- Gives child gifts without reason
- Tries to be a child’s friend instead of an adult role
- Does not have an age-appropriate relationship
- Spends time alone with children outside of their role in the child’s life or makes excuses to be with the child
- Expresses unusual interest in child sexual development
- Engages in touching a child when parents or child have indicated that it is unwanted.

CITY UTH COMMITMENT FORM

I am committed to serving twice a month for 3 months at City UTH.

I, _____ am committed to abiding by the policies and procedures of City Uth listed above during the time I am serving in City UTH.

_____

Signature

_____

Date